

School of Arts and Humanities

Philosophy (BA)

Philosophy is one of the most broad-based, rigorous, interdisciplinary, and socially engaged of the liberal arts. Philosophy poses deep, important, and persistent questions concerning the nature of the good life, why we believe and how we know, the nature of the self and its connection with the world and with society, and the foundations of justice. Philosophy takes up such questions through critical analysis of textual evidence, clear and rigorous argumentation, and questioning of unexamined personal and cultural assumptions. The study of the history of philosophy from all cultures proves central to this process.

Far from being an abstruse, removed, and self-contained pursuit, Philosophy at UT Dallas engages in an interdisciplinary Arts & Humanities program, drawing on and contributing to the study of history, literature, and the arts. Our program is also particularly suited to the STEM excellence of UT Dallas, with a practical and theoretical emphasis on the philosophy of science, technology, and medicine. Finally, the UT Dallas Philosophy BA program strives to be highly pluralistic and intellectually diverse, with emphases in continental, analytic, feminist, American, and non-Western philosophical traditions.

Since the following catalog course descriptions offer very general descriptions, students are urged to consult the detailed course descriptions available on the web site for the School of Arts and Humanities. At least one-half of the semester credit hours for a major must be taken at UT Dallas.

Bachelor of Arts in Philosophy

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)¹

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professor: Charles R. Bambach, Jonathan Tsou

Assistant Professors: Katherine Davies, Songyao Ren

Professor of Instruction: Lawrence Amato

Associate Professor Emeritus: Peter Park

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours²

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

[PHIL 2303](#) Introduction to Logic³

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select one of the following:

[PHIL 1301](#) Introduction to Philosophy³

[PHIL 1305](#) Introduction to Philosophy of Religion³

[PHIL 1306](#) Introduction to Ethics³

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses

II. Major Requirements: 42 semester credit hours

Major Preparatory Courses: 0 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum⁴

[PHIL 2303](#) Introduction to Logic³

Select one of the following:

[PHIL 1301](#) Introduction to Philosophy³

[PHIL 1305](#) Introduction to Philosophy of Religion³

[PHIL 1306](#) Introduction to Ethics³

Major Core Courses: 6 semester credit hours

[PHIL 3321](#) Philosophical Traditions I

[PHIL 4328](#) Philosophy Capstone Project

Major Distribution Courses: 12 semester credit hours

6 semester credit hours of lower- or upper-division courses in *History of Philosophy* from two *different* periods

[PHIL 2316](#) History of Philosophy I

or [PHIL 3322](#) Ancient Philosophy

[PHIL 2317](#) History of Philosophy II

or [PHIL 3323](#) Early Modern Philosophy

[PHIL 3324](#) 19th and 20th Century Philosophy

Courses with other numbers may be considered for this distribution requirement on a case-by-case basis, when their syllabus indicates that they focus primarily on the history of philosophy.

3 semester credit hours of upper-division courses in *Metaphysics, Epistemology, and Science*

[PHIL 3373](#) Philosophy of Mind

[PHIL 4308](#) Theories of Knowledge

[PHIL 3328](#) History and Philosophy of Science and Medicine

[PHIL 4321](#) Philosophy of Medicine

[PHIL 4344](#) Philosophy of Science

Courses with other numbers may be considered for this distribution requirement on a case-by-case basis, when their syllabus indicates that they focus primarily on metaphysics, epistemology, or philosophy of science.

3 semester credit hours of upper-division courses in *Ethics, Values, and Society*

[PHIL 3375](#) Contemporary Ethical Issues

[PHIL 3320](#) Medical Ethics

[PHIL 3338](#) Literary Theory and Aesthetic Philosophy

[PHIL 4323](#) Ethical Theories

[PHIL 4324](#) Social and Political Philosophy

[PHIL 4325](#) Philosophy of Art and Aesthetics

Courses with other numbers may be considered for this distribution requirement on a case-by-case basis, when their syllabus indicates that they focus primarily on value theory.

Major Elective Courses: 18 semester credit hours

18 semester credit hours of upper-division Philosophy electives, including Major Figures, Great Texts, Traditions, and Topics courses.

Major-Related Courses: 6 semester credit hours

Students must select 6 semester credit hours of courses from the following list of courses with significant philosophical content:

Any [RELS](#) course

[ARHM 3100](#) Topics in Values and Science

[ARHM 3342](#) Advanced Interdisciplinary Studies in the Arts and Humanities

[ATCM 3300](#) Code Plus Culture⁵

[ATCM 4384](#) Ethics in New Media, Technology, and Communication

[CGS 2301](#) Cognitive Science

[CGS 3325](#) or [PSY 3360](#) Historical Perspectives on Psychology: Mind and Machines since 1600⁵

[CGS 4320](#) or [PSY 4320](#) Psychology of Reasoning⁵

[CGS 4362](#) or [PSY 4362](#) Perception⁵

[COMM 3351](#) History and Theory of Communication

[COMM 3352](#) Media and Culture

[COMM 4360](#) Communication Ethics

[ECON 4301](#) Game Theory⁵

[ECON 4381](#) History of Economic Ideas

[GST 2300](#) Introduction to Gender Studies

[HIST 3302](#) Gender in Western Thought

[HIST 3376](#) American Intellectual History, Colonial to the Civil War

[HIST 3377](#) American Intellectual History, Civil War to the Present

[HIST 4380](#) Topics in Intellectual History

[IPEC 4305](#) Topics in Science, Technology and Institutions

[LIT 3316](#) The Literature of Science Fiction

[LIT 3317](#) The Literature of Fantasy

[LIT 3330](#) Linguistics

[OBHR 4310](#) Business Ethics⁵

[PSCI 3301](#) Political Theory

[PSCI 3303](#) Civil Liberties

[PSCI 3306](#) Political Economy

[PSCI 4328](#) Fake News

[PSCI 4334](#) Approaches to Peace

[PSCI 4357](#) Human Rights

[PSY 3324](#) Psychology of Gender

[PSY 3331](#) Social Psychology

[PSY 4325](#) Death and Dying

[SOC 2305](#) Individual and Society

[SOC 2320](#) Contemporary Social Issues

[SOC 3303](#) Classical Social Theory⁵

Other courses from prefixes besides PHIL may be considered for this requirement on a case-by-case basis, when their syllabus indicates that they have significant philosophical content.

III. Elective Requirements: 36 semester credit hours

Free Electives: 36 semester credit hours

Both upper- and lower-division courses may be used as electives, but students must complete at least 51 semester credit hours of upper-division courses to qualify for graduation.

Philosophy majors interested in graduate study should strongly consider using some of their free electives for foreign language study in a language that would support an area of their philosophical interest. Similarly, students with a primary interest in areas of philosophy that depend on outside domains of knowledge (such as philosophy of science or philosophy of mind) should consider using some of their free electives for advanced study or a minor in the relevant field.

Students may want to consider using some free elective credit to complete one of the approved minors offered by UT-Dallas, and should consult their academic advisor for more information about their choices.

Incoming freshmen must enroll in and complete requirements of [ARHM 1100](#).¹

1. Incoming freshmen must enroll and complete requirements of UNIV 1010 and the corresponding school-related freshman seminar course. Students, including transfer students, who complete their core curriculum at UT Dallas must take UNIV 2020.
2. Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.
3. A required Preparatory course that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours may be counted in Core Curriculum.
4. 0 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum, if the student has not previously completed other courses to satisfy these core curriculum requirements.
5. These courses may have prerequisites not listed in the degree plan, and may add to the

student's time to degree.

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